The Front Page of the Internet: Sentiment and Engagement in Reddit Mental Health Subreddits

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Abstract

In this study, we analyze posts from the subreddits r/depression, r/anxiety, r/ptsd, r/relationship_advice, and r/SuicideWatch to examine whether engagement varies by posting time and emotional tone. The dataset was collected in R using the RedditExtractoR package and includes post metadata such as timestamps, text, and number of comments. To evaluate time differences, we used exploratory visualizations and nonparametric statistical tests. We then estimated a negative binomial regression model with weekday, time interval, and sentiment as predictors of comment count. The results show little to no evidence that weekday or posting hour alone explains engagement, while sentiment analysis gave us some interesting results. In particular, posts with more positive sentiment tend to receive more comments, and afternoon posts show relatively higher engagement than posts made at other times. Our findings suggest that textual tone may be more informative than posting time when analyzing interaction patterns in online mental health communities.

1. Introduction

Reddit is often dubbed "the front page of the internet." While Instagram and Facebook are more mainstream and common among the older population, Reddit is more nuanced in terms of diversity and unfiltered content.

The platform is built upon **subreddits**: self-governing, specialized micro-communities that cater to every human interest imaginable. From the world of tarot card readings to the very specific adoration of golden retrievers, these subreddits allow for a level of engagement that Facebook groups rarely achieve.

What truly distinguishes the Reddit user is a characteristic lean toward critical inquiry, cynical humor, and niche expertise. Unlike the Mainstream Web, where content is often simplified for general appeal, Reddit culture is built around layers of irony. However, this same unfiltered and ironic nature can be a double-edged sword. The lack of a real-world identity attached to a profile allows users to bypass social stigmas, leading to a level of radical honesty, particularly regarding personal struggles. This level of raw transparency is hard to find on mainstream sites where your boss or grandmother might be watching platforms where the content rarely gets deeper than a minion meme from 2012. Because of this unique environment, Reddit has become an unintentional repository for high density data regarding human behavior and mental health. With over 100,000 active subreddits, the platform functions as a massive study on the human condition.

To narrow the scope of our analysis, we have focused on a selection of various subreddits that act as digital sanctuaries for those in crisis. These communities provide a clearer, more raw window into the internal lives of users than traditional surveys might allow. Our research centers on:

- **r/depression & r/anxiety:** For chronic mood and cognitive struggles.
- **r/ptsd:** A specialized space for trauma processing.
- **r/relationship_advice:** A massive cross-section of interpersonal conflict and social dynamics.
- **r/SuicideWatch:** A critical, high-stakes environment for acute crisis intervention.

By analyzing comments and posts within these specific communities, we aim to bridge the gap between digital behavior and clinical mental health trends, exploring how anonymity influences the way we seek help or express hopelessness in the 21st century.

2. Dataset

In our study, the dataset we have used was collected from Reddit using the RedditExtractoR package in R. The dataset consists of posts and comments collected from r/depression, r/ptsd, r/relationship_advice, r/anxiety and r/SuicideWatch. Reddit data are a form of digital trace or found data, which means that the dataset is not designed specifically for research purposes.

For each subreddit, we collected thread URLs and we also retrieved post content. The post data consists of title, number of comments, and subreddit. The comment data provided difficult to work with because of the RedditExtractoR package, so we decided to only look at post data, but we still retain the number of comments. These variables were merged into the main dataset so that we get a more robust result. As There will be a discussion the research question later, we have transformed the dataset into a workable format by deriving time-based variables from the post timestamps, including hour of day and day of week.

The final dataset we finally got allows us to study how posting time, popularity and comment volume are associated with mental health topics on Reddit.

Here is an overview of our dataset:

Column name	Description
subreddit	Source subreddit
title	Post title
date_raw	Raw timestamps
comments_n	Number of comments
query_sort	Sorting method used
text	Post text content
query_period	Time window used
created_datetime	Parsed post time
weekday_utc	Posting weekday
hour_utc	Posting hour
time_bin	time interval

Table I

2.1 Ethics

We recognize that mental health is deeply personal and sensitive. User anonymity was our ethical priority during both the data collection and reporting phases. While raw post data including titles, comments, and metadata was important for conducting statistical analysis, several ways of data protection were implemented to protect and guard the users.

To maintain users' anonymity, all usernames and personal identifiable information were stripped from the dataset prior to the generation of any findings. Furthermore, the results presented in this report focus exclusively on population level trends rather than on an individual level. No direct or searchable text is included in our findings. We did this design specifically to prevent doxxing, ensuring that the original users cannot be re-identified through their phrasing or specific life details. We prioritized this way of de-identified reporting so that we can adhere to the ethical norms of statistical research.

3.Motivation and Aim

Reddit's subreddit structure creates topic specific communities which make us researchers' job easy since Reddit is filled with valuable forms of self-disclosure and interaction that may be less visible in more public social media environments such as Instagram. Reddit plays an important role in mental health discourse, social support, and anonymity in mental illness communities. These features make it suitable for examining how users communicate about mental health related issues in online environments.

Now we focus our attention on our research questions and try to pinpoint our aim. The central aim of our study is to examine whether time intervals and engagement indicators are associated with mental health related posts on Reddit. We analyzed the timing of posts, such as hour of day or day of week, and see if these are related to differences in the emotional characteristics of posts, and whether post popularity, measured through comment count, is related to these same characteristics.

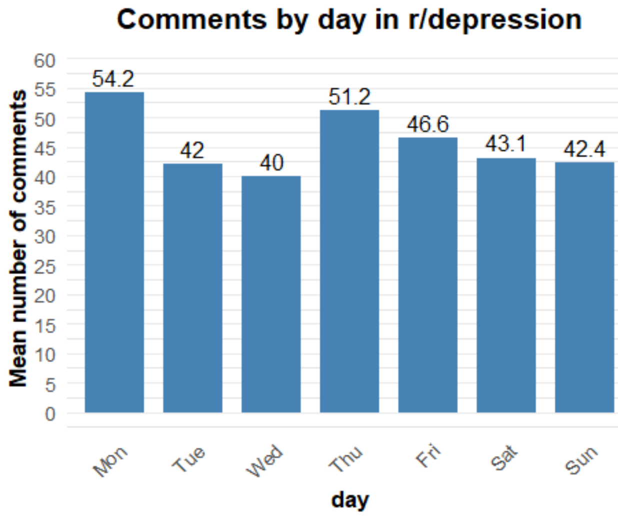
At the same time, one should be aware of the limitations of such data. Reddit users are not representative of the general population; in fact, they can be considered as outliers from the population as Reddit users have a bad reputation according to some people [1] and social media based data are subject to self-selection. Accordingly, the aim of this study is exploratory and analytical rather than representing an entire population.

4. Approaches

We decided to examine comment count as our main engagement indicator and conducted a naïve analysis of how comment count varies with the time when posts were published. Our goal is not yet to make strong inferential claims; we just want to explore whether any visible temporal patterns appear in the data. Since posting time may shape how many users are online, how quickly discussions form, and how visible a thread becomes, it is reasonable to first inspect whether posts made on different days or during different parts of the day receive different levels of comments.

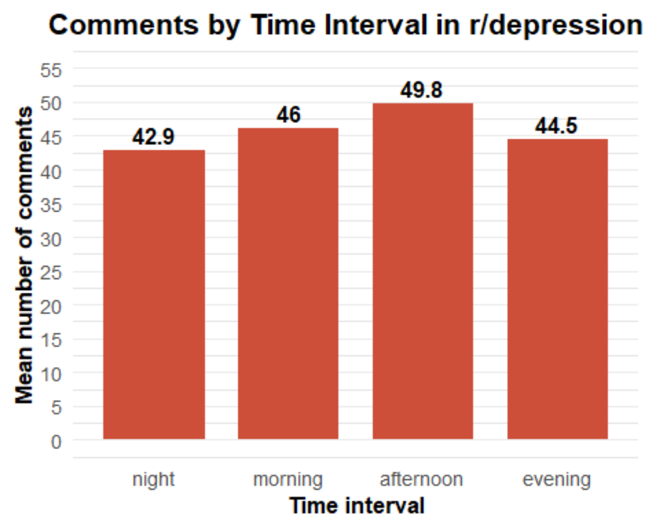
Before moving to statistical modelling, it is useful to visualize the data. It allowed us to see possible outliers, and subgroup differences across subreddits. They allow us to see whether comment counts appear to vary by weekday, hour of posting, or broader time intervals such as morning, afternoon, evening, and night. These graphs do not establish causality. They provide an important first step in understanding the structure of the data. More specifically, we focused on three questions. First, do some weekdays appear to generate more discussion than others? Second, are certain hours of the day associated with higher comment counts?

Third, do these patterns look similar across the selected subreddits, or does each community show a different level of engagement? The following plots are intended to provide an intuitive overview of these patterns:



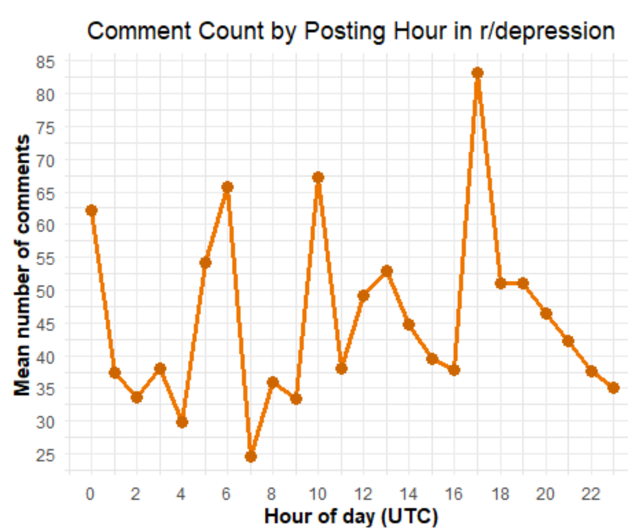
Graph I

We chose r/depression to be our subreddit for the graphs, mainly to provide a clear example for the exploratory stage of the analysis. The *graph I* suggest that Monday shows the highest average engagement, with a mean comment count of 54.2, followed by Thursday. Wednesday appears to have the lowest average engagement among the weekdays shown. But *graph I* alone does not provide an explanation for why these differences happen. While one could speculate that engagement rises toward the end of the workweek or due to stress and fatigue, these interpretations would be an oversimplification of anxiety and depression. What the graph shows is that engagement is not distributed evenly across the week. And it may have some statistical reasons behind it.



Graph II

Here in *graph II*, we can see that most of the comments were posted in the afternoon. And rarely at night. We will test the validity of the count and how powerful it is through statistical tests.



Graph III

Graph III shows us that The pattern for the engagement is not constant over the day but instead fluctuates noticeably by hour. There is a peak around 17:00 UTC, where posts receive the highest average number of comments, while several lower-engagement periods appear during the early morning and around 07:00 UTC. We vaguely deduce that temporal structure of engagement is not simply linear or monotonic.

4.1 Statistical Analysis

Now we shift our focus on some of the methodologies we have used to advance our graphical explanatory data analysis. In order to test if average comment count changes for the day, we have utilized one-way analysis of variance (ANOVA). And we have also suggested other methods which we will discuss after ANOVA.

4.1.1 Analysis of Variance (ANOVA)

A natural and naïve analysis for comparing comment activity across weekdays is ANOVA. Since the descriptive graphs suggest that the average number of comments may differ depending on the day on which a post was made, ANOVA is simple for testing whether these group means are equal. Let Y_{ij} denote comment count for the i and weekday group j. we can write the equation for the ANOVA like this:

$$Y_{ij} = \mu + \alpha_j + \varepsilon_{ij}$$

Where μ is the overall mean of the comment count and α_j is the effect of the weekday and ε_{ij} is the standard error. Then we write the hypothesis:

$$H_0: \mu_{Mon} = \mu_{Tue} = \mu_{Wed} = \mu_{Thu} = \mu_{Fri} = \mu_{Sat} = \mu_{Sun}$$

against the alternative that at least one weekday mean differs. The ANOVA test statistic is based on the ratio of between-group variation to within-group variation:

$$F = \frac{MS_{between}}{MS_{within}}$$

Now that the theory behind ANOVA is covered, we move on to some assumptions and cons of our analysis. ANOVA is a natural starting point but it relies on assumptions that are not especially well suited to the present data. In particular, the dependent variable in our project, comment count, is a count variable that is non-negative, typically right skewed, and often includes outliers.

Classical ANOVA assumes approximately normally distributed residuals and homogeneity of variance across groups. Given the distributional features of Reddit comment counts, these assumptions are unlikely to be true to our setting. As a result, ANOVA on the raw comment counts does not provide the most reliable inference.

Source	Df	Sum Sq	Mean Sq	F value	Pr(>F)
weekday_utc	6	2.20	0.3673	0.876	0.513
Residuals	193	80.92	0.4193		
Total	199	83.12			

Table II

As we can see from the *Table II* p value is bigger than 0.05 we fail to reject the null hypothesis, so we conclude that there is no statistical difference between means of comment count across weekdays. We did these analyses for each five subreddits and none of them gave us a p value less than 0.05 we can conclude that mean values of comment count are equal. But as we have said that ANOVA assumes normality, and we must test that. We have utilized Shapiro-Wilk normality test. Which tests whether the residuals are normally distributed so that it will suffice the normality assumption. All subreddits' p values were less than 0.05 suggesting that they are not normally distributed. So, using ANOVA is not ideal for these subreddits. We move forward with the Barlett test to analyze the constant variance assumption:

$$H_0: \sigma^2_{Mon} = \sigma^2_{Tue} = \cdots = \sigma^2_{Sun}$$

$$H_1: \text{At least one variance differs.}$$

$$B = \frac{1}{C}\left\{(N-K)\ln(MSE) - \sum_{i=1}^{K}(n_i - 1)\ln(S_i^2)\right\}$$

Where C:

$$C = 1 + \frac{1}{3(k-1)}\left\{\left(\sum_{i=1}^{k}\frac{1}{n_i - 1}\right) - \frac{1}{n-k}\right\}$$

We have tested these assumptions according to the test. Only r/relationship_advice gave us a p value bigger than 0.05. Suggesting that r/relationship advice's variance is constant.

4.1.2 Kruskal–Wallis Test

A more robust alternative to ANOVA is the Kruskal–Wallis test. While ANOVA compares group means under assumptions such as approximate normality and equal variances, the Kruskal–Wallis test is a nonparametric method that compares the distributions of the outcome variable across groups using ranks instead of raw values. This makes it more suitable when the dependent variable is skewed or contains extreme observations, as is often the case for Reddit comment counts.

In our setting, the test is used to evaluate whether the distribution of comment counts differs across weekdays within each subreddit.

Let Y_{ij} denote the comment count for observation i in weekday group j. The null hypothesis is that the weekday groups come from the same distribution:

$$\begin{aligned} H_0:\ F_{\text{Mon}}(y) &= F_{\text{Tue}}(y) = F_{\text{Wed}}(y) \\ &= F_{\text{Thu}}(y) = F_{\text{Fri}}(y) \\ &= F_{\text{Sat}}(y) = F_{\text{Sun}}(y) \end{aligned}$$

H_1: At least one weekday distribution differs

The Kruskal–Wallis test statistic is defined as:

$$H = \frac{12}{N(N+1)}\sum_{j=1}^{k}\frac{R_j^2}{n_j} - 3(N+1)$$

N = total number of observations
k = number of groups
R_j = sum of ranks in group j
n_j = number of observations in group j

Under the null hypothesis, the test statistic is approximately chi-square distributed with $k-1$ degrees of freedom: $H \sim \chi^2_{k-1}$

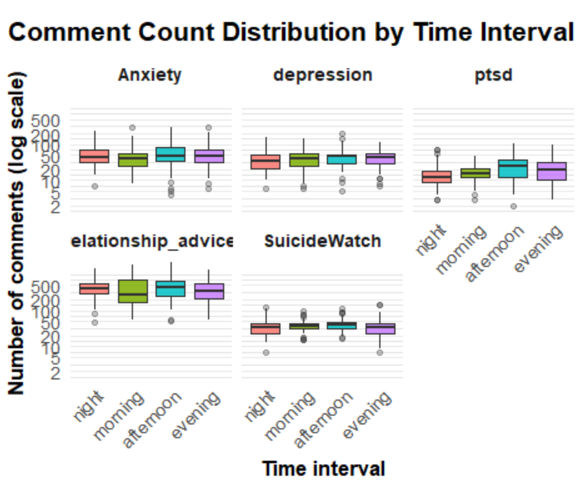
Subreddit	Statistic	p.value
Anxiety	6.9	0.330
SuicideWatch	3.92	0.688
Depression	7.59	0.27
PTSD	0.972	0.987
Relationship_advice	2.21	0.899

Table III

For each subreddit, a Kruskal–Wallis rank-sum test was conducted to assess whether comment counts varied across weekdays. In no case was the test statistically significant. The largest test statistic was observed for r/depression H = 7.59, p = 0.27, followed by r/Anxiety H = 6.90, p =0.33, but both results remain non-significant. These findings indicate that weekday differences in comment activity are not robust, despite some variation in descriptive averages. For the other analyses we will be moving on with Kruskal–Wallis rank-sum test. As it is more robust and reliable.

4.1.3 Time Bin Analysis

Now we shift our focus on the time bins specifically the night-day differences. And see if there is any meaningful analysis we can discover.



Graph IV

Visual analysis of the boxplots suggests distinct patterns over time intervals. However, descriptive graphs do not provide a meaningful interpretation for statistical significance. To move beyond exploratory observation, we once again conducted some tests.

Null Hypothesis:

$$H_0: F_{\text{night}}(y) = F_{\text{morning}}(y) = F_{\text{afternoon}}(y) = F_{\text{evening}}(y)$$

Alternative Hypothesis:

H_1: At least one time-bin distribution differs

Now we can calculate the test statistics using R. note that k = 4.

Subreddit	Statistic	p.value
Anxiety	2.53	0.469
SuicideWatch	4.96	0.175
Depression	2.56	0.465
PTSD	9.86	**0.0198**
Relationship_advice	2.55	0.466

Table IV

As we can see from table V only r/PTSD has a meaningful p value so we will conduct a pairwise Wilcoxon rank-sum tests.

4.1.4 Pairwise Wilcoxon Rank-Sum Tests

After the Kruskal–Wallis test, The next step is to determine which specific groups differ from each other. The Kruskal–Wallis test only tells us whether at least one group differs, but it does not identify the location of these differences. For that reason, we conduct pairwise Wilcoxon rank-sum tests as post-hoc comparisons.

This means comparing the distribution of comment counts between each pair of time intervals within the subreddit r/PTSD. For any two groups $a$and b, the null hypothesis is that the distributions of the outcome are the same:

$$H_0\colon\ F_a(y) = F_b(y)$$

The alternative hypothesis is that the two group distributions differ:

$$H_1\colon\ F_a(y) \neq F_b(y)$$

The Wilcoxon rank-sum test is based on the ranks of the pooled observations rather than their raw values. Suppose the two groups contain $n_a$and $n_b$observations, respectively. After pooling all observations and assigning ranks, let $R_a$denote the sum of ranks for group a. The Wilcoxon rank-sum statistic can be written as:

$$W = R_a$$

A closely related form is the Mann–Whitney Ustatistic:

$$U = W - \frac{n_a(n_a + 1)}{2}$$

Under the null hypothesis, the expected value of U is:

$$E(U) = \frac{n_a n_b}{2}$$

and its variance is:

$$\mathrm{Var}(U) = \frac{n_a n_b(n_a + n_b + 1)}{12}$$

Using these quantities, the standardized test statistic can be approximated by:

$$Z = \frac{U - E(U)}{\sqrt{\mathrm{Var}(U)}}$$

	Afternoon	Evening	Morning
Evening	0.25	-	-
Morning	0.069	0.25	-
Night	0.053	0.069	0.25

Table V

For the PTSD subreddit, the Kruskal–Wallis test for time bins was statistically significant H= 9.86, p = 0.0198 indicating that the overall distribution of comment counts differs across at least some of the four time intervals. However, the pairwise Wilcoxon comparisons did not identify any individual pairwise significance that remained at the 5% level. This pattern is not contradictory however the Kruskal–Wallis test evaluates the joint evidence across all groups, whereas the pairwise tests examine specific contrasts and are subject to reduced power.

4.1.5 Hourly Analysis

We decided to make a more detailed analysis so in addition to comparing engagement across weekdays and broader time bins, we also examine whether comment counts vary across posting hours. The hourly analysis provides a detailed view of temporal patterns, since the time-bin variable may conceal variation within broader parts of the day. For example, two posts made in the evening may still differ a lot if one is posted at 17:00 and another at 23:00. For this reason, analyzing the hour of posting allows us to assess whether engagement changes more precisely over the course of the day.

As in the previous analyses, the dependent variable is the number of comments received by a post. Since this variable is non-negative, skewed, and often affected by outliers, a nonparametric approach is again appropriate for the first stage of the hourly comparison. We therefore use the Kruskal–Wallis test to evaluate whether the distribution of comment counts differs across the 24 hourly groups.

Let Y_{ih} denote the comment count for post i posted during hour h, where $h \in \{0,1,\ldots,23\}$.

The null hypothesis states that the distribution of comment counts is the same across all posting hours:

$$H_0\colon\ F_0(y) = F_1(y) = F_2(y) = \cdots = F_{23}(y)$$

The alternative hypothesis is that at least one hourly distribution differs:

H_1: At least one hourly distribution differs

because there are 24 hourly groups, the total number of pairwise comparisons becomes very large:

$$\binom{24}{2} = \frac{24 \cdot 23}{2} = 276$$

Subreddit	Statistic	p.value
Anxiety	23	0.46
SuicideWatch	16.6	0.783
Depression	25.5	0.323
PTSD	23.3	0.442
Relationship_advice	28.5	0.196

Table VI

Although the hourly time series plot suggested visible peaks and dips in engagement, those apparent fluctuations are not statistically strong enough to conclude that comment-count distributions differ by posting hour. In other words, the observed hourly variation is consistent with random sample variation.

5. Machine Learning

Now that most of our tests are statistically insignificant, we decided to shift our focus on the machine learning part. We also thought of including the textual tone of posts into the analysis. The motivation for this step is that engagement on Reddit may depend not only on when a post is published, but also on what kind of emotional content the post is trying to tell. In these subreddits, the tone of a post may be especially relevant, since more emotional or more supportive posts may invite different levels of discussion.

For this reason, we constructed a sentiment variable from the text associated with each post. Using the vader package in R, we generated sentiment scores from the available text field in the dataset. VADER is a sentiment tool designed for short, informal, online text, which makes it suitable for Reddit style content. For each post, the procedure produces several sentiment indicators, including positive, neutral, and negative components, as well as a compound sentiment score. In the present analysis, we use the compound score as the main sentiment measure. This variable provided a continuous summary of the overall emotional tone of the text, where lower values indicate more negative sentiment and higher values indicate more positive sentiment.

They allowed us to explore whether more positive or more negative posts tend to receive different levels of engagement.

Temporal differences alone may not capture the full structure of engagement. A post published on Thursday afternoon may receive many comments not simply because of the day and time, but because of its wording, tone, or emotional intensity makes it more likely to get more responses. Including sentiment therefore provides a more meaningful model of engagement.

After creating the sentiment variable, we estimated a negative binomial regression model in order to predict the expected number of comments from three sets of predictors: weekday, time interval, and sentiment. We chose this model because the dependent variable, comment count, is a non-negative count variable and exhibits clear overdispersion. Which makes ordinary least squares inappropriate and makes the Poisson model too restrictive. The negative binomial model is more flexible because it allows the conditional variance to exceed the conditional mean.

Formally, let Y_i denote the number of comments received by post i. We assume:

$$Y_i \sim NB(\mu_i, \alpha)$$

where μ_i is the expected number of comments and α is the dispersion parameter. The mean structure is modeled using a log link:

$$\log(\mu_i) = \beta_0 + \sum_{d=1}^{6} \gamma_d D_{id} + \sum_{t=1}^{3} \delta_t T_{it} + \beta_1 \text{Sentiment}_i$$

where:

- D_{id} are weekday dummy variables,
- T_{it} are time-bin dummy variables,
- Sentiment_i is the sentiment score of post i.

Variable	IRR (exp(coef))
(Intercept)	159.692
weekday_utc2	1.159
weekday_utc3	1.135
weekday_utc4	1.497
weekday_utc5	1.349
weekday_utc6	1.045
weekday_utc7	0.977
time_bin_evening	0.521
time_bin_morning	0.728
time_bin_night	0.760
sentiment	1.620

Table VII

Variable	Estimate	Std. Error	z value	Pr(>|z|)
(Intercept)	5.07325	0.11237	45.147	<2e-16
weekday_utc2	0.14787	0.13851	1.068	0.285
weekday_utc3	0.12702	0.13921	0.912	0.361
weekday_utc4	0.40377	0.13644	2.959	0.003
weekday_utc5	0.29933	0.13521	2.214	0.02684
weekday_utc6	0.04436	0.13723	0.323	0.746
weekday_utc7	-0.02319	0.13522	-0.172	0.863
time_bineveni ng	-0.65278	0.09714	-6.720	1.82e-11
time_binmorn ing	-0.31776	0.11614	-2.736	0.006
time_binnight	-0.27451	0.10637	-2.581	0.009
sentiment	0.48249	0.04678	10.315	<2e-16

Table VIII

In the estimated model, Monday was used as the reference category for weekday and afternoon as the reference category for time intervals as we decided that Mondays are a nightmare for everyone and afternoons are annoying. This means that all weekday coefficients are interpreted relative to Monday, while the time-bin coefficients are interpreted relative to afternoon posting.

The regression results show that sentiment is a strong positive predictor of comment count. The estimated coefficient for sentiment is positive and highly statistically significant. Incidence rate ratio is approximately 1.62. This means that, holding weekday and time interval constant, a one unit increase in the sentiment score results in about a 62% increase in the expected number of comments. In other terms, posts with more positive sentiment tend to generate more comments.

The time-bin effects are also important. Relative to afternoon posts, posts made in the evening, morning, and night all receive significantly fewer expected comments. However, for evening posts the complete opposite is true, whose incidence rate ratio is approximately 0.52, meaning that 47.9% fewer expected comments compared to afternoon posts. Morning and night posts also show lower expected comment counts, with incidence rate ratios with 0.73 and 0.76, respectively. These results suggest that, once sentiment is taken into account, the afternoon remains the most live period in the data.

The weekday effects are more selective. Compared with Monday, Thursday and Friday are associated with significantly higher expected comment numbers. The incidence rate ratio for Thursday is approximately 1.50, which corresponds to about 49.7% more expected comments than Monday. The incidence rate ratio for Friday is approximately 1.35, corresponding to about 34.9% more expected comments than Monday. The remaining weekdays do not differ significantly from Monday after controlling for sentiment and time.

The interpretation of the model should remain cautious. First, the sentiment score is a simplified numeric of textual tone and it cannot capture the full meaning of mental health related language. Second, the data consists of highly visible Reddit posts rather than a representative sample of all posts or all users. Third, as we statisticians like to say: *correlation doesn't mean causation*. Thus, while the results suggest that more positive posts and afternoon posts tend to receive more comments, they do not establish that changing the wording or timing of a post would necessarily cause engagement to rise.

6. Conclusion

The conclude, we examined engagement patterns in several mental health related Reddit subreddits by analyzing post timing, comment counts, and textual sentiment. Using data collected from multiple subreddits, we explored whether time variables such as weekdays, hour of posting, and time intervals influence the level of comments generated by a post.

The exploratory visualizations suggested that engagement levels might vary across days and time intervals. However, formal statistical tests did not give us strong indication on the significance of temporal effects. The ANOVA analysis failed to detect significant differences across weekdays, and the Kruskal Wallis tests similarly indicated that most subreddit comment distributions do not differ significantly by weekday or posting hour. Although a significant result was observed for the time bin analysis in the r/PTSD subreddit, Pairwise comparisons did not reveal clear differences between individual time intervals.

Because comment counts are skewed and overdispersed, we extended the analysis using a negative binomial regression model that includes time variables and sentiment scores derived from post text. The regression results suggest that sentiment is a strong predictor of engagement. Posts with more positive sentiment tend to receive a significantly higher number of comments, while posts made outside the afternoon generally receive fewer responses.

These findings indicate that engagement in mental-health-related Reddit discussions is driven more strongly by the emotional tone of posts than by the exact time they are published. While temporal patterns may appear in descriptive statistics, they are not consistently supported by inferential tests. This highlights the importance of considering textual and emotional content when studying online social interactions.

Several limitations should be acknowledged. Reddit users do not represent the general population as we said before in our discussion, and the analysis relies on publicly visible posts rather than a complete record of user activity. Also, we sorted the posts by popularity for 1 year and then collected our data. In addition, sentiment scores cannot fully capture the complexity of mental health subreddit posts. Future research could extend this work by analyzing full comment threads. We couldn't do this due to technical reasons which RedditExtractoR package gave us. So, we are hoping that future researchers can apply our methods and build more upon it.

Overall, our study demonstrates that Reddit provides a valuable dataset for understanding online users' mental health. By combining statistical analysis with sentiment modeling, we gain an overview into how emotional communication shapes engagement within online support communities.

References

[1] *Reddit - The heart of the internet*. (2024). Reddit.com. https://www.reddit.com/r/NoStupidQuestions/comments/1g0buut/why_redditors_have_bad_reputation